MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

Cloud Infrastructure / DevOps Candidate | QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with experience building and maintaining CI/CD pipelines, Kubernetes-based ephemeral test environments, and test infrastructure. Hands-on with GitLab CI, Helm, Docker, Linux, and PostgreSQL, with additional personal project experience running a k3s cluster using GitOps and provisioning Hetzner VPS infrastructure with Terraform. Strong focus on automation, reliability, observability, and clear technical documentation. Seeking to transition into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure and delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal project), Argo CD

Containers and systems: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm deployments), k3s, Linux, Ansible (basic)

Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL

Programming and automation: Python, Bash, Java (test code)

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (free-tier learning); Hetzner VPS (personal project)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies, and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; reduced monthly CI runner costs by approximately 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral test environments using Docker Compose and later Helm charts deployed to a shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built tooling in Bash and Python to seed PostgreSQL test data.
- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards to highlight flaky tests by team.
- Wrote the internal guide to CI pipelines, which is used in team onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Performed manual and automated testing of web and mobile applications across client projects.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Ran a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Implemented short-lived environments for merge requests, deployed via GitLab CI and Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against each environment.
- Automated cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Helped teams identify and address frequent test failures; the flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 1%.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching, and separated end-to-end testing into its own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by approximately 30%.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation | In progress; exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)